

HAND-QUILTED CUSHION

Hand quilting uses running stitch to hold the layers of the piece together. This lovely cushion cover with a slit opening at the back gives you a chance to try

out this simple technique. The finished cover has authentic handmade charm.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

Easy

SIZE

40 x 40cm (16 x 16in)

TOOLS AND MATERIALS

Rotary cutter
Scissors
Cutting mat
Quilter's ruler
Pins
Safety pins
Large-eyed needle
Threads to match your fabrics
Contrasting embroidery thread
Sewing machine
Iron and ironing board
40cm (16in) square cushion pad

FABRICS

43 x 43cm (17 x 17in) patterned front fabric
88 x 52cm (35 x 20½in) backing fabric
45 x 45cm (17¾ x 17¾in) wadding

SKILLS

Hand quilting (see pp.132–133)

SEAM ALLOWANCE

1cm (¾in) seam allowance throughout, unless otherwise stated

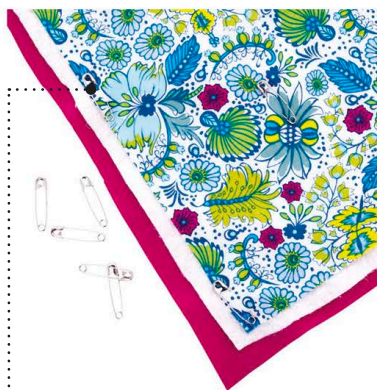
TIP

If you find it easier, use tailor's chalk and a ruler to draw stitching guidelines, or use masking tape to mark straight lines.

PATTERN



1 For the cushion front, lay a 46 x 46cm (18 x 18in) square of backing fabric on a flat surface. Centre the wadding on top of the backing fabric, then centre the patterned front fabric on top of that.



2 Starting from the centre and working outwards, pin the backing, wadding, and front fabric together using safety pins. Make sure that all the layers lie flat and check that the underside of the backing fabric also lies flat (see p.44).



3 Starting at one corner and using a large-eyed needle and a length of embroidery thread, use stab stitch (see p.133) to sew a line through all three layers of fabric. Make the stitches and the gap between them about 6mm (¼in) long. At the opposite edge, tie the thread off at the back.